

How to Make: Chaos Blades

I've always been a big fan of Chaos Daemons. When I started Warhammer back in 2012, the first armies to catch my interest were daemons. The codex art bled so much emotion in such simple paint strokes. Bloodletters howled their fury, Nurglings were balls of mutated flesh and Lords of change showed an alien intelligence. When looking at the images, I could really *feel* what each daemon stood for.



Bloodletter, Nurglings and Lord of Change made by John Blanche
(<https://johnblancheprints.com>)

It's from these artworks that I made my bloodletters. I really wanted to show their fury onto the tabletop. Sure, I could have highlighted each muscle and nail, but that would distract from the overall intent of the model. Instead, I picked 2 components to focus on, the face and the blade. The face to shows fury and forward momentum, while the blade to makes the model feel dangerous.

This PDF will focus on the blade. The skin and color grading will be part of another guide.

The Blade

Concept

When we think of rage, we often imagine heat. Fury can boil oceans, melt steel and crush stone. I took inspiration from nature and settled on a lava effect. This makes each blade look powerful and full of energy, ready to be unleashed upon the enemy! *(or Ally! It's Khorne after all)*



Lava Flow by Volcano Discovery

<https://www.volcanodiscovery.com/photo-of-the-day/2017-apr-18.html>

The colors range from a deep black to a bright white. Daemons are creatures of extremes, and the model should represent that. The colors will be:

White Scar
Yriel Yellow
Trollslayer Orange
Rhinox Hide
Black Legion

Painting the blade



1) Start by base coating the entire blade Yriel Yellow. We'll need 3-4 layers to get a nice smooth coat. Take your time with this step, as it will be our main layer.

For airbrush users, spray the entire blade titanium white instead.



2) Glaze a White Scar in the middle of the weapon. Thin it down more than usual, to about a milky consistency. Apply multiple layers leaving a small edge to each next layer. We want a gradient built up from the yellow to the white center of the blade

Airbrush: Spray the start and end of the blade with Yriel Yellow.



3) Paint the edges of the blade with Trollslayer Orange. Apply a second layer closer to the edge than the first to create another gradient. You can also apply some dots on the open spaces to make it more interesting.



4) In the same way as our previous step, apply a layer of rhinox hide. Don't apply too much of this, we want enough orange to show through.



5) Last, apply a final layer of Black Legion across the very edge of the blade. This step really brings out the intensity of the white. And with that we're done!



Example: This model was done using an airbrush and had less white in the blade. The same method can be achieved using glazes and patience.

Final Result



Afterthoughts

This guide had a bit more background behind it due to the steps themselves being so simple. For the blade itself, I probably used too much white in the middle. If the yellow had more presence it would have added a lot more charm to the weapon itself. Then again, Warp-based weapons rarely look alike, so the herald wielding a brighter variant makes sense.

I hope this guide could help some of you out! If you guys try this method out for yourself, I'd love to see them!

